

Ambulatory Urodynamics (Sensor Test)

Patient Information · A bladder test with small sensors instead of tubes

WARWIKI

This is a newer way to test how your bladder works. Instead of tubes, small sensors record pressure while your bladder fills **naturally as you drink**. You can move around the clinic and urinate normally during the test. The goal is to see how your bladder behaves in a more everyday way than a standard test allows.

About This Test

A standard urodynamics test uses thin tubes and fills the bladder with fluid. This test is different:

- A small, soft **bladder sensor** is placed through the urethra. A thin string hangs out so it can be removed.
- In many cases, a second small sensor is placed in the **rectum**. It measures belly pressure, so the team can tell bladder squeezing apart from straining.
- Your bladder fills **naturally as you drink**. You urinate normally with the sensor in place, into a device that measures your stream.
- The sensors **store the readings**. The results are downloaded after the sensors come out.

The test is done in the clinic, and you can walk around during it. It may help when a standard test did not show your symptoms, or when a tube made it hard to urinate.

Is It Safe?

In early studies, no serious problems were seen. Some people had mild blood in the urine, burning or discomfort, which cleared on its own. Some found placing the sensor more uncomfortable than standard tubes, but about 2 in 3 said they would choose it for a future test. This test does not replace every part of a standard test. Your team will explain what it can show for you.

Learn the Terms

Ambulatory

Done while you walk and move around, not lying still.

Bladder sensor

A small, soft device placed in the bladder that records pressure.

Rectal sensor

A small device in the rectum that records belly pressure.

Removal string

A thin thread used to pull the sensor out gently.

Natural filling

Your bladder fills on its own as you drink, instead of through a tube.

Void

To urinate. You do this normally with the sensor in place.

Voiding diary

A log of drinks, urges and trips to the toilet. It may be kept on an app.

Urodynamics

Tests that measure how the bladder stores and empties urine.

Will it hurt? Placing the bladder sensor usually takes less than a minute and feels like brief pressure or discomfort. Afterward, most people can move and urinate normally. Removal takes a few seconds: the sensor is gently pulled out by its string.

How to Get Ready

- Plan to **stay at the clinic** for the time your team describes, and to drink fluids.
- Take your **usual medicines**, but ask whether to stop any bladder medicines first.
- If asked, **record** when you drink, feel urges and urinate.

Tell your team ahead of time if you:

- Have signs of a **urine infection** (burning or fever). The test may need to be moved.
- Have a **spinal cord injury**. Your blood pressure may need watching.
- Have had surgery on your urethra or prostate, have an artificial urinary sphincter, take a blood thinner, or have allergies

What Happens During the Test

- 1 The bladder sensor is placed through the urethra with a small tool. A rectal sensor may also be placed.
- 2 You drink and move about while the sensors record.
- 3 You urinate normally into a device that measures your stream.
- 4 At the end, the sensors are gently removed by their strings.

After the Test

- You can go back to **normal activities right away**.
- Mild **burning when you urinate** for a day or so is common. Drinking extra water helps.
- A **pink tinge** in the urine for a short time is common and usually clears within a day.

Call the office that did your test if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Burning or pain that gets worse instead of better
- A weak stream, or you feel you are not emptying

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate for several hours and your bladder feels full or painful
- Your urine looks like red wine or has clots
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. Small sensors record your bladder as it fills naturally.
2. Plan to drink fluids and stay at the clinic for the test.
3. It adds to a standard test but does not replace every part of it.